

The Heart of the Vidyā Mantra of the Noble Eleven-Faced One

Āryamukhadaśaikāvidyāmantra-hṛdaya-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 694 · Derge Kangyur

འཕྱུག་པ་ཞལ་བཅ་བྱ་ཅག་པའ་རིག་སྒྲུལ་གཏུན་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའ་གི་བཟུངས།

Toh 694 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Āryamukhadaśaikāvidyāmantra-hṛdaya-nāma-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as "The Heart of the Vidyā Mantra of the Noble Eleven-Faced One," belonging to the broader category of dhāraṇī and mantra literature associated with Avalokiteśvara in his eleven-faced form. The text presents itself in the sūtra style, opening with the standard narrative frame of the Buddha dwelling at Śrāvastī surrounded by a great assembly of monastics, bodhisattvas, and non-human beings, before introducing its central dhāraṇī teaching. As its title suggests, it focuses on the heart-essence of the vidyā mantra connected to this multifaced emanation of Avalokiteśvara, a form widely venerated for his compassionate activity. The text was translated into Tibetan by the great editor-translator Yeshé Dé, one of the most prolific and important figures of the early Tibetan translation period.

Translated by the great editor-translator, the venerable Yeshé Dé, who rendered, revised, and established the text.

In the language of India: Āryamukhadaśaikāvidyāmantra-hṛdaya-nāma-dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The dhāraṇī called "The Heart of the Vidyā Mantra of the Noble Eleven-Faced One."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling in Śrāvastī, in the midst of a circle of śāla-tree shoots, together with a great Saṅgha of twelve hundred and fifty monks, and with an immeasurable and innumerable assembly of great bodhisattvas. Chief among those bodhisattvas was Maitreya.

Moreover, at that time the Blessed One was surrounded by an immeasurable assembly of monks, nuns, male lay practitioners, female lay practitioners, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (fragrance-eaters), asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras (half-human beings), great mahoragas (serpent-spirits), kumbhāṇḍas, flesh-eating spirits, humans, and non-humans, and the rest — all of them encircling him, paying him homage and honor, venerating him, holding him as

supreme. And in their midst he was teaching the Dharma on the recitation of secret mantras.

Then the great bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, surrounded by tens of millions, hundreds of thousands, and an immeasurable number of sages (ṛṣis) holding vidyā mantras, came into the presence of the Blessed One. He bowed his head to the two feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated him three times to the right, and stood to one side. He then addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, I possess a heart of vidyā mantra called the Eleven-Faced One, endowed with great power, which was spoken by one hundred and ten million buddhas. Today I shall proclaim it in order to bring healing and happiness to all sentient beings, to pacify all disease, to purify all wrongdoing, to avert all inauspiciousness, to prevent all evil dreams, to avert all untimely death, to tame those of malicious mind and bring them to a state of peace, to bring happiness to those afflicted with the suffering of grief, to reconcile those who bear enmity, to pacify māras and all obstructing spirits, and to bring to complete fulfillment the aspirations of the mind.

"Blessed One, I have protected this world — with its gods, its māras, its Brahmā, its ascetics and brahmins — with this vidyā mantra. Whoever is protected by this vidyā mantra, whoever receives it, holds it, reads it, recites it, or writes it out and propagates it — for all such persons, no obstruction shall be made, no māra's interference, no harm by weapons, clubs, poisons, or any kind of sorcery.

"As for the direction in which this vidyā mantra is present — whether far or near — so long as one does not transgress the boundaries established there, I see no harm coming to anyone. The only exception is one whose sinful karma has already become ripe for definitive maturation.

"Blessed One, having understood with certainty that things are truly thus, one should take this up with genuine confidence. One should not engage in conceptual doubt. If one acts in this way, all obstructing spirits, being driven far off, will draw near and yet find no opportunity to cause harm. This heart of the vidyā mantra has been praised in equal measure by all buddhas, who rejoice in it equally and without exception. It has been considered and perfectly guarded by all the Tathāgatas.

"Blessed One, I well remember that in the past, at a time as many eons ago as there are grains of sand in the river Gaṅgā —"

— a Tathāgata, arhat, fully and perfectly awakened, appeared in the world by the name King of Light Rays of Greatly Expanded Qualities, Lord of the Uṣṇīṣa Free of the Eye of a Hundred Lotuses. At that time I had become a sage, and from that Blessed One I received this vidyā mantra. The moment I obtained this vidyā mantra, I beheld the buddhas of all ten directions, and I attained the patience of the unborn nature of phenomena (anutpattikadharmakṣānti). Because of this, know that this vidyā mantra is endowed with great power.

Therefore, sons and daughters of good family and all others who are endowed with complete faith, if they wish to take up this vidyā mantra, to hold it, to read it, and to recite it, let them do so with reverence, with one-pointed mindfulness, rising early each morning and purifying themselves in accordance with the Dharma. If they recite this vidyā mantra one hundred and eight times, they will obtain in this very life ten kinds of benefit. What are the ten? Their bodies will constantly be free of illness. They will be continuously held and protected by the buddhas of all ten directions. They will enjoy wealth, jewels, clothing, and food without deficiency. All enemies will be subdued and they will be free from fear. They will be honored and spoken of in terms of praise by the noble and venerable. They will not be harmed by poisons or by possession by demons. They will not be harmed by any weapon or cudgel. Water will not be the cause of their death. Fire will not be the cause of their death. They will not meet with untimely death.

Moreover, they will obtain four further benefits, like medicinal virtues. At the time of death they will behold the buddhas. They will never fall into the lower destinies. They will not meet with death while still holding on to agitation and confusion. And they will be born in the world-realm of Sukhāvatī.

Blessed One, I also well remember that in the past, at a time even further back than a time as many eons ago as there are grains of sand in ten rivers Gaṅgā — a Tathāgata, arhat, fully and perfectly awakened appeared in the world by the name Fragrance of Mandārava Flowers. At that time I had become a great householder, and from that buddha I received this vidyā mantra. The very moment I obtained this vidyā mantra, I transcended four hundred thousand eons of cyclic existence.

Furthermore, those who read and hold this vidyā mantra will also obtain the gateway to the liberating Dharma that is the essence of the primordial wisdom of the great compassion of all the buddhas, and the gateway to liberation of all bodhisattvas. Through the power and strength of this, it fully protects those

who are bound in tight imprisonment, those sentenced to the prison of death, those who contemplate drowning, and those beset by all manner of hindrances and sufferings — water, fire, wind, brigands, poisons, sorcerous harm, humans, non-humans, and the like.

By virtue of this, I have become the abode, the refuge, the full protector, the complete guardian, the breath of relief, the island, and the home for all sentient beings. Through the power of this vidyā mantra, all malevolent yakṣas, rākṣasas, and the like are fully drawn in and seized, and having previously been given the arising of a mind of loving-kindness and a mind of compassion,

Following that, I have established them in unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening. Blessed One, through the power of the great majestic splendor of this vidyā mantra of mine, even if someone recites it just once, all four root downfalls and all five acts of immediate retribution will be utterly purified — so what need is there to speak of practicing it exactly as it has been taught? As for those who have accumulated roots of virtue before innumerable, incalculable hundreds of thousands of myriads of buddhas, and who have now come to hear this vidyā mantra — what need is there to speak of their receiving it, holding it, and practicing it exactly as it has been taught?

If someone reads, recites, and holds this vidyā mantra as a canopy's inscription, I shall cause all their wishes and aspirations to be fulfilled just as desired.

If someone fasts on the eighth, the fourteenth, or the fifteenth of the month, takes up the vow properly, purifies themselves fully in accordance with the Dharma, focuses the mind one-pointedly in recollection of me, and recites this vidyā mantra, then forty thousand eons of cyclic existence will be compressed and worn away.

Blessed One, through the power of this vidyā mantra, my name will become rare and difficult to hear. Yet if someone recites and mentally contemplates the names of innumerable, incalculable hundreds of thousands of myriads of buddhas, and if another person, with a sincere mind, simply recalls and invokes my name for even a single instant, the merit of both is equal and the same. All those who invoke my name shall attain the ground of non-return; they shall be freed from all disease and suffering; they shall be liberated from all obscurations and all fears; and the transgressions of body, speech, and mind shall be purified and cleansed. So what need is there to speak of

receiving, holding, reading, reciting, and practicing this vidyā mantra exactly as I have taught it? Know well that those persons will comprehend and truly come to possess unsurpassable awakening as though it were right in the palm of their hands.

Then the Blessed One praised the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara with words of acclaim, saying: "Excellent! Excellent! Noble son, having aroused such an intention of loving-kindness and compassion toward all sentient beings, you have revealed and expounded this great vidyā mantra. Through the power of this skillful means, you have fully protected and liberated all sentient beings from the suffering of illness, from obscurations, hindrances, fears, and the faults of body, speech, and mind, and have established all sentient beings in unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening. Noble son, I too rejoice in this and, having fully received your vidyā mantra, now ask you to recite it."

Then the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, rose from his seat, drew his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee upon the ground, and addressed the Blessed One in these words:

"Whoever recites this vidyā mantra should speak thus: I bow with reverence to the Three Jewels. I bow with reverence to the noble Tathāgata, the Victor adorned with the ocean of wisdom, Vairocana. I bow with reverence to all Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas. I bow with reverence to the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, possessed of great compassion."

The mantra is as follows:

tadyathā oṃ dhara dhara dhiri dhiri dhuru dhuru iṭṭe vaṭṭe cale cale pracale
pracale kusume kusuma vare ili mili citi citi jvala mapanaya śuddhātā svāhā
mahākāruṇikāya svāhā

Blessed One, this is the root vidyā mantra. Whoever recollects and recites it will obtain the especially exalted qualities described above.

I bow with reverence to the Three Jewels. I bow with reverence to the noble Tathāgata, the Victor adorned with the ocean of wisdom, Vairocana. I bow with reverence to all Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas. I bow with reverence to the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, possessed of great compassion.

tadyathā ha ha ha ha ili mili cili pili khili hili svāhā

Blessed One, this is the mantra to be applied to water and to clothing. Whenever anyone wishes to enter the maṇḍala, they should first bathe, and then this mantra should be recited seven times over water, which is then sprinkled upon the body to purify it. Furthermore, this mantra should be recited seven times and the new garments should then be put on.

I bow with reverence to the Three Jewels. I bow with reverence to the noble Tathāgata, the Victor adorned with the ocean of wisdom, Vairocana. I bow with reverence to all Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas. I bow with reverence to the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, possessed of great compassion.

tadyathā dhuru dhuru ha ha ha svāhā

Blessed One, this is the mantra to be applied to incense powder and to lamps. When one has entered the maṇḍala and burns incense powder as an offering, this mantra should first be recited seven times over the incense powder before it is burned. Likewise, when one wishes to light lamps, this mantra should first be recited seven times over sesame oil, and then the lamps should be lit.

I bow with reverence to the Three Jewels. I bow with reverence to the noble Tathāgata, the Victor adorned with the ocean of wisdom, Vairocana. I bow with reverence to all Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas. I bow with reverence to the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, possessed of great compassion.

tadyathā siri siri dhiri dhiri siri dhiri svāhā

Blessed One, this is the mantra to be applied to flowers, to anointing unguents, and to garlands. When one has entered the maṇḍala and makes offerings of flowers, anointing unguents, and garlands, this mantra should first be recited seven times over the flowers, which are then scattered upon the image. Likewise, this mantra should be recited seven times over the anointing unguent, which is then applied to the image. And again, this mantra should be recited seven times over the garlands, which are then used to adorn the image.

I bow with reverence to the Three Jewels. I bow with reverence to the noble Tathāgata, the Victor adorned with the ocean of wisdom, Vairocana. I bow with reverence to all Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas. I bow with reverence to the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, possessed of great compassion.

tadyathā sate sate siti siti sudhu sudhu svāhā

Blessed One, this is the mantra to be applied to the food offered and presented to the buddhas. Whoever offers food and

When making offerings of flowers, fruits, and the like to the buddhas, one should first recite this mantra twenty-one times and apply it, and only thereafter proceed to make the initial offering.

I bow with reverence to the Three Jewels. I bow with reverence to the noble Tathāgata, the Victor adorned with the ocean of wisdom, Vairocana. I bow with reverence to all Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas. I bow with reverence to the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, possessed of great compassion.

tadyathā masita siti cale cale huru huru curu curu suru suru muru muru svāhā

Blessed One, this is the mantra to be applied to the tooth-wood. If someone performs the root mantra taught above, this mantra is to be applied once to a śata-flower tree. If one wishes to expel worms, one should separately take wood of the śata-flower tree, cut it into thirty pieces, and soak the pieces in a mixture of yogurt, butter, and honey. After leaving them to soak for a day, one takes each piece one at a time, recites the mantra once over each, and throws each piece into the afflicted place. All of these are then to be burned as a burnt offering, and after that one should carry out whatever initial rites are required.

I bow with reverence to the Three Jewels. I bow with reverence to the noble Tathāgata, the Victor adorned with the ocean of wisdom, Vairocana. I bow with reverence to all Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas. I bow with reverence to the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, possessed of great compassion.

tadyathā ili mili bili tili cili hili svāhā

Blessed One, this is the mantra for purifying a boundary. If one wishes to purify a boundary, one should recite this mantra seven times over water and scatter it in the four directions. Alternatively, one may recite the mantra seven times over white mustard seeds or clean ash and scatter them in the four directions, and however large a bathing area one has in mind — near or far — that space will be entirely protected as a boundary.

I bow with reverence to the Three Jewels. I bow with reverence to the noble Tathāgata, the Victor adorned with the ocean of wisdom, Vairocana. I bow with

reverence to all Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas. I bow with reverence to the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, possessed of great compassion.

tadyathā biṭe biṭe tiṭe tiṭe ciṭe ciṭe biṭṭhe biṭṭhe kaca kaca bhagavān
āryāvalokiteśvarāya sabha sabha sabhanam svāhā

Blessed One, this is the mantra for dismissing oneself back to one's own place. When one has completed whatever rites were to be performed and wishes to depart back to one's own abode, one should recite this mantra seven times over water and scatter it in the four directions, and then one may depart and return.

Blessed One, although this knowledge-mantra has not yet fully manifested its attainments, by performing its various applications and reciting it with one-pointed mind, there is no aspiration whatsoever that will go unfulfilled.

As for someone who is afflicted by an intoxication disease that arises once for each piece of wood, or twice for each piece of wood, or three times for each piece of wood, or four times for each piece of wood — whether the affliction was caused by a demon spirit, or by a ḍākinī, or by flesh-eating beings, or by a corpse, or by a maddening agent, or by a cause of forgetfulness —

— or by a demon-spirit of various malevolent kinds — if this mantra is applied to those patients one hundred and eight times, they will recover.

If the obscuration is a heavy one, recite the mantra once for each knot while tying knots in a five-colored thread, completing one hundred and eight knots in all, and then bind it around the patient's neck or upper arm. The non-virtuous obscurations will be dissolved and purified, and the affliction will be healed.

If someone is afflicted and tormented by any of the various malignant ailments such as swellings, chains of abscesses, tumors, protrusions of the eye, weeping wounds, or scabies — or if they have been struck by a sword, an arrow, a lance, or the like and have gone mad — or if they have been seized by a snake, by a scorpion, by a wasp, by a bee, or by a venomous creature, and they are thereby tormented — recite this mantra seven times and apply it, and they will recover.

If the obscuration is a heavy one, apply the mantra seven times to yellow sulphurous clay and smear it on the afflicted area being tormented, and it will be dispelled.

If someone is ill with a wind disorder (vāta disease), or has been affected unilaterally on one side of the body, or is suffering from deafness, or blockage of the nose, or illnesses caused by wind possession and similar conditions that cause torment — recite this mantra with one-pointed mind and apply it to those patients one hundred and eight times, and the illness will be healed.

If the obscuration is a heavy one, boil grain-oil, water-butter, barley flour, and costus root together, apply the mantra seven times, and then rub this on the body, or pour it into the ears and nose, or offer it as a drink, and the affliction will be healed.

Furthermore, if someone is tormented by other ailments and various kinds of affliction, apply this mantra with one-pointed mind. Or, if one recites it oneself, the person will recover.

Now, if one wishes to accomplish this knowledge-mantra, one should carve from white sandalwood that is hard and springy and free from blemish an image of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara that is half a fathom in height, standing upright. In the left hand he holds a fully opened lotus blossom and a vase. The right hand is extended holding a rosary, displaying the gesture of granting fearlessness. He is fashioned with eleven faces. The three faces in front bear the marks of loving-kindness and compassion. The three faces on the left side bear the marks of a wrathful aspect. The three faces on the right side bear the marks of white fangs bared upward. The single face at the back bears the marks of great ferocity and supreme rarity. The single face at the crown bears the form of a buddha's countenance. Within each of those head-ornaments, buddha-forms are likewise seated. The body of this bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara is adorned with various ornaments such as a necklace and so forth.

Once the image has been made, whoever wishes to have their aspirations fulfilled should don fresh, clean clothing, undertake fasting, and properly take the vow. From the first day to the eighth day of the bright fortnight of the white month, beneath a single parasol, at three times of day, recite this mantra one hundred and eight times, or else an immeasurable number of times.

From that point onward, in a secluded place, lay down a clean seat, place the image of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara that has been fashioned there, turn it to face westward, make offerings of food and drink according to whatever one's means allow, and burn only agarwood and costus as incense.

The yogin should then partake of food consisting of grain flour and milk, and continue the recitation as before, until the third session of the day is complete.

From that point onward, the offerings and their implements are to be arranged in a manner that surpasses and excels those of before.

The yogin is to partake of only these three white foods: milk, yoghurt, and rice.

Take wood from the tree of awakening and place it upright before the image. Furthermore, take that same wood and cut it into one thousand and eight pieces, set them within a vessel of ghee made from the milk of a dri, and then, taking one piece at a time for each session, recite the mantra once for each piece and cast it into the fire. When all have been offered, at that moment the great earth will tremble and quake violently, and by the power of that, the image that has been fashioned will also tremble greatly. Then, from the mouth of the face set upon the upper part within it, a sound will arise, and it will say these words to the yogin: "Excellent! Excellent, son of noble family! Because you have sought, with such earnest and diligent aspiration, to accomplish all these wishes, I shall fulfill your aspirations completely. You shall fly through the sky and travel thus, or else you shall move and travel with no obstruction whatsoever, or else you shall become a king among sages and vidyādhara (holders of mantra knowledge), or else you shall become, just as I am, entirely autonomous and unobstructed." Thus it will speak words of praise.

Furthermore, on the fifteenth day of the bright fortnight of the white month, the yogin should place the image of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara with eleven faces inside a stūpa that contains the relics of a buddha. Wearing fresh, clean clothing, properly taking the restoration vow and the precepts, and observing strict fasting throughout a single day and night, take one thousand and eight jasmine flowers, and for each flower, recite the mantra once and offer it. When all have been offered, at that moment a sound like the roll of thunder will arise from the mouth of one face before the fashioned image, and by the power of that the great earth will also tremble violently. The yogin should at that time settle his own mind in ease, not giving rise to fear or alarm, and should recall inwardly only the knowledge mantra and whatever aspiration and accomplishment he has undertaken. He should then say: "I bow with reverence to the great bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, endowed with great compassion. May I, at some time, become the protector and refuge of all sentient beings, and may I fulfill the aspirations of the minds of all sentient beings." If he says this, at that moment Avalokiteśvara will

bestow whatever aspirations have been made, and when he bestows those aspirations, no god (deva), nāga, or any other being will be able to create obstacles or impediments.

Furthermore, when the moon enters a planetary conjunction, the yogin should take one sraṅga weight of water, place it in a silver vessel before the fashioned image, and recite the mantra over it. The moon, just as before, having come under the power and protection of the mantra, once that water has been obtained and used, there is no skin disease of the body whatsoever that will not be cured.

Furthermore, the yogin should take equal parts of henbane and civet, place them before the fashioned image, recite this mantra one thousand and eight times, and sprinkle it with water. Then, applying a drop of this to the forehead, three kinds of aims will be accomplished.

Combined with warm water as taught before and used for bathing, all obstacles and obstructing spirits, and all malignant skin diseases, will be cleared away and healed.

Furthermore, if enemy forces come to seize one by force in battle, take one fruit of red orpiment, recite this mantra over it one hundred and eight times, and anoint the face of the wrathful countenance on the left side of the fashioned image. Then, if it is turned to face the direction of the enemy, the enemy's assembled forces will be unable to draw near.

Furthermore, if an epidemic should break out among people and livestock in a region, before the fashioned image perform the rite of the juniper fire-offering, and also take that wood, cut it into one thousand and eight pieces, pick up one piece at a time, anoint it with mustard oil, recite the mantra once, and cast it into the fire. Continue in this way until all pieces have been consumed.

Furthermore, tie seven knots in a red cord, tying one knot and reciting the mantra once with each knot. Then, having placed it on the crown of the head of the loving and compassionate face on the front of the image, leave it there for a fixed number of days, then untie it and tie it around the neck of the sick person, and all epidemic diseases will be thoroughly pacified. When the epidemic has subsided, the mantra cord too is to be untied and removed.

Furthermore, if someone is suddenly seized by possession from a ḍākinī or an elemental spirit and begins to dance and cry out in distress, tie twenty-one knots in a white cord, reciting the mantra once and tying one knot with each

recitation. Then, having placed it on the crown of the head of the loving and compassionate face on the front of the image, leave it there for a fixed number of days, then untie it and tie it around the neck of the sick person, and the possession illness will be cured.

If the karmic obscuration is heavy and the person has not recovered, take that mantra cord, recite the mantra over it again one hundred and eight times, place it on the crown of the previously fashioned image, leave it for a fixed number of days, then untie it and tie it around the neck of the sick person, and without doubt that person will recover.

Furthermore, if someone is afflicted by a persistent endemic epidemic and is suffering without recovering, or if malignant spirits and obstructors have entered a household, take one hundred and eight juniper berries, and before the fashioned image, pick up each berry one at a time, recite the mantra once over it, and cast it into the fire. Continue in this way until all have been consumed.

Furthermore, tie twenty-one knots in a white cord, reciting the mantra once and tying one knot with each recitation. Then, having placed it on the crown of the head of the loving and compassionate face on the front of the image, leave it for a fixed number of days, then untie it and tie it around the neck of the sick person, and the epidemic diseases will be cleared away and the malignant obstructors and harmful spirits will be scattered and dispersed.

Furthermore, if an enemy is seeking an opportunity to harm one, is quarreling and disputing, or is working harm through binding-spells and curses, offer flowers, incense, and various other offerings to the fashioned image, kindle a fire before the image of Vināyaka, take one hundred and eight juniper berries, recite the mantra once over each, and cast them into the fire.

Furthermore, tie one hundred and eight knots in a white cord, reciting the mantra once and tying one knot with each recitation. Then place it on the crown of the wrathful face on the left side of that image, leave it for four days, and then untie it. Take that cord, name the enemy by name, and, separating each knot from the others and hiding them in different places apart from one another, recite the mantra once over each and cut through each one until all have been dealt with. That enemy will then be unable to accomplish whatever they intend to do and will themselves come to seek refuge with you.

Furthermore, if someone wishes to accomplish an excellent aim, tie one hundred and eight knots in a five-colored cord, reciting the mantra once and

tying one knot with each recitation. Then before the fashioned image, recite the mantra seven times, and

place it on the crown of the head of an image with a face expressing loving-kindness and compassion, leave it there for a day, then untie it and wear it on your own body — and all your aspirations will be fulfilled just as you wish.

Furthermore, if someone is beset by obscuring obstacles such that most of their wishes for good things go unfulfilled, or inauspicious circumstances arise repeatedly without cause, then wash the image that was fashioned from fragrant water.

Moreover, charge water with the mantra one hundred and eight times and wash the image of Vināyaka with it.

Moreover, charge water with the mantra one hundred and eight times and sprinkle it upon your own body — and all obscurations and obstacles will dissolve of their own accord, and all your aspirations will be fulfilled just as you wish.

At that moment, the bodhisattva, the great being Avalokiteśvara, having spoken those words, the entire vast assembly gave voice together in great praise, saying: "Excellent! Excellent, O great being! For the sake of benefiting all sentient beings you have proclaimed this awareness-mantra. We too rejoice and aspire to uphold it fully." And then the entire vast assembly was filled with joy and delight, and having circumambulated the Blessed One three times and made prostrations, they departed.

This concludes the dhāraṇī called "Avalokiteśvara of Eleven Faces."

Translated from the Chinese source text by the abbot-translator of the great revision, the venerable Chö Drup, a disciple in the tradition of the Blessed One, and established as the definitive version through checking and editing.

Translator's Notes

- The term rendered "circle of śāla-tree shoots" translates the Tibetan "འདྲིང་གློ་བུ་རྒྱ་སྐྱེས་ཀྱི་མཚན་པོ།," which literally means "in the maṇḍala of the shoots of the śāla tree" (the śāla being the tree associated with the Buddha's final passing, though here indicating a grove or sacred enclosure of young śāla trees). Some translators render this simply as "a grove of śāla saplings," which is equally defensible.

The phrase rendered "one hundred and ten million buddhas" is a literal reading of "百十億那由他の如來," meaning eleven sets of ten million (kotī), equivalent to one hundred

and ten million.

- The epithet of the first buddha named here is very long and syntactically complex in Tibetan. The rendering "Lord of the Uṣṇīṣa Free of the Eye of a Hundred Lotuses" follows the Tibetan literally, though the exact Sanskrit reconstruction of this buddha-name is uncertain and the phrase may admit alternative parsing.

The phrase rendered "patience of the unborn nature of phenomena" renders *anutpattikadharmakṣānti*, a standard Great Vehicle term for the direct realization that phenomena are unborn; this is consistent with standard Mahāyāna usage.

The last sentence of the passage breaks off mid-thought in the Tibetan source itself; this is not a translation error but reflects the passage continuing beyond the excerpt given.

- The phrase rendered "rare and difficult to hear" reflects a standard formulation indicating that the name or teaching in question is of such supreme virtue that encountering it is an extraordinary event, not that the speaker's name will literally become obscure. The contrast that follows — equating the merit of invoking Avalokiteśvara's name once sincerely with reciting the names of countless buddhas — makes this doctrinal point clear.

The expression "forty thousand eons will be compressed and worn away" translates a compressed formula for the purification of karmic accumulations accrued over an immense span of cyclic existence.

The mantra syllables are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan phonetic rendering and represent a standard dhāraṇī associated with Avalokiteśvara; no attempt has been made to normalize or emend them against Sanskrit attestations, as the Tibetan phonetic spelling is itself the received liturgical form.

- The passage presents a series of ritual mantras, each preceded by the same threefold homage formula and followed by instructions for its specific liturgical use. The term rendered "incense powder" translates a word that can refer to powdered incense meant for burning, which fits the context of the lamp and incense offering section. The text breaks off mid-sentence at the close, as it continues in the next passage.

- The term rendered "tooth-wood" refers to a small stick used for cleaning the teeth, a common ritual implement in Indian Buddhist practice, here specified as coming from the śāta-flower tree (Tibetan: me tog sha ta'i shing). The identity of this tree is uncertain; it may correspond to the śāta or related Sanskrit botanical name.

The phrase rendered "expel worms" (zhugs 'bud pa) likely refers to the expulsion of parasitic worms or insects from the body, a common category of ritual medical treatment in this genre of text.

The passage ends mid-sentence, as the source text is incomplete at this point.

- The phrase rendered "chains of abscesses" translates a term meaning a series or garland of abscesses or glandular swellings, likely referring to scrofula or a similar condition; the garland-like formation is the key diagnostic image. The term rendered "protrusions of the eye" likely refers to exophthalmos or a similar condition of bulging eyes. The compound rendered "yellow sulphurous clay" refers to a pale yellow ochreous or sulphurous earth used in traditional medical applications. The passage on the image describes the canonical iconography of Eleven-Faced Avalokiteśvara (Ekādaśamukha Avalokiteśvara); the rendering follows standard iconographic description rather than imposing later systematized arrangements.

- The phrase rendered "wood from the tree of awakening" translates byang chub kyi shing, which literally means "the tree of awakening" or "bodhi tree." In ritual contexts this most likely refers to a branch or wood taken from a peepal tree (*ficus religiosa*), the species of tree under

which the Buddha attained awakening, used here as a ritual material for fire offerings (homa). This is a genuine doctrinal-contextual point worth noting.

The term dri (female yak) is implied by the specific mention of "ghee made from dri milk," which is a standard ritual specification in Tibetan texts; "ghee" alone would not convey the ritual precision.

The plant rendered "henbane" for ldon ros is uncertain; the identification of this medicinal or ritual plant is not settled in the secondary literature. Similarly, "civet" for gi wang is a common Tibetan rendering of an aromatic animal product, though some scholars identify it differently.

- The term rendered "juniper fire-offering" renders a compound that literally means "juniper fire-pit offering" or "juniper fire-puja"; the ritual context makes clear this is a homa-style burnt offering using juniper wood and later juniper berries, so the two instances are distinguished in context but translated consistently. The phrase "red orpiment" for རྩམ་མེད་མེད་མེད་མེད་མེད་ translates a compound likely denoting a red mineral pigment of the orpiment family; the identification is approximate and could also refer to a related red sulfide mineral. The "image of Vināyaka" appearing in the hostile-enemy rite alongside the principal fashioned image is a notable doctrinal-ritual detail: Vināyaka is the obstacle-deity whose own image serves as the locus of the fire ritual in this context.

- The colophon names the translator as "Bande Chö Drup" (Bandhe Chos grub), a monk-scholar who worked from a Chinese exemplar rather than a Sanskrit original — a noteworthy detail for text-critical purposes, as this dhāraṇī sūtra entered the Tibetan canon via Chinese transmission rather than directly from Sanskrit. The title "Zhuchengyis mkhan po lo tsā ba" indicates he held the rank of chief editor-translator in the great revision bureau (the Zur Chen revision associated with the imperial-period retranslation project).

The term "Vināyaka" in the text refers to a class of obstructing spirit, not to the Hindu deity Gaṇeśa in his benevolent aspect; in the ritual context here it denotes a malevolent obstacle-causing being whose image is washed as part of a purification rite.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.